

in diplomacy, Dr. Kanodia brings to philanthropy a rare blend of empathy and execution. It is this duality—heart and discipline—that has defined her work across education, healthcare, women's empowerment, sports, and environmental sustainability.

Since its inception in 2019, the M3M Foundation under her leadership has impacted over 4.8 million lives across 22 states, three union territories, 851 villages and 85 districts—a scale that places it among India's most credible social institutions. Yet, for Dr. Kanodia, numbers are only the beginning. The real measure of success, she often says, lies in whether dignity becomes durable and opportunity becomes systemic.

Dr. Kanodia's growing presence on international platforms reflects the evolution of Indian philanthropy itself. No longer confined to local action, today's Indian social leadership is increasingly global in its outlook—connecting grassroots realities with global conversations on equity, sustainability and inclusive growth. At forums such as the Vatican Summit on Faith and Philanthropy and global leadership platforms in Europe, she has consistently articulated a simple but powerful belief: that emerging economies like India are no longer just recipients of global solutions—they are now architects of them.

Her participation at Davos this year comes at a defining moment—not just for her personally, but for the Indian development narrative. As the world debates climate responsibility, inclusive growth and ethical capitalism, Dr. Kanodia brings to the table a model that integrates all three.

Under Dr. Kanodia's stewardship, sustainability at M3M Foundation is not treated as an isolated vertical—it is embedded across programmes.

From large-scale tree plantation drives such as Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam, which has seen over 200,000 saplings planted, to rural waste-management initiatives like Katran, which turns discarded fabric into livelihood opportunities for women artisans, the Foundation's approach reflects what she calls "environmental

responsibility with economic dignity". In rural clusters across Haryana, Odisha and Rajasthan, M3M Foundation's sustainability framework links climate action with community resilience—combining water conservation, green skilling, and circular-economy models that ensure environmental protection also generates income.

At Davos, Dr. Kanodia is expected to highlight how Indian CSR can move beyond compliance to become a global template for climate-conscious development—where sustainability is not a checkbox, but a value system that influences how organisations build, employ, and invest.

One of the defining pillars of Dr. Kanodia's philanthropy has been women's empowerment—not merely as beneficiaries, but as economic stakeholders.

Through programmes that focus on entrepreneurship, digital literacy, skilling and workforce participation, the Foundation has enabled thousands of women to move from informal labour to formal opportunity. Her former leadership at FICCI YFLO Delhi further amplified this mission, reaching over a million women through initiatives that promoted leadership, innovation and financial independence. At Davos, this narrative of women as catalysts of sustainable growth resonates deeply with global priorities. Dr. Kanodia's work demonstrates that when women participate economically, resilience multiplies—not just for families, but for entire ecosystems.

What sets Dr. Kanodia apart in India's philanthropic landscape is her insistence on continuity. "My goal" she has often said, "is not to create moments of charity, but institutions of care". This philosophy has guided the Foundation's long-term investments in education through Saakshar, in healthcare access, and in sports development through Lakshya, which supports over 100 athletes across India. Her belief is simple yet radical: development must outlive intention. And that is why, whether it is rural entrepreneurship through the Triveni Awards, climate-

linked livelihoods, or women-led micro-enterprises, each initiative is designed to sustain itself beyond its founders.

Recognised with honours such as the Karmaveer Global Fellowship, CSR Person of the Year, the Mahatma Award, and titles like Leader of Hope and Custodian of Humanity, Dr. Payal Kanodia today stands at the intersection of business excellence and transformative philanthropy. Yet, she wears these accolades lightly. For her, leadership is not about visibility—it is about velocity: how quickly impact travels from intent to implementation.

As India enters its 'Amrit Kaal' and the world looks to emerging economies for solutions to climate, inequality and inclusive growth, voices like hers matter more than ever. At Davos, Dr. Kanodia will not just represent an organisation or a foundation—she will represent a philosophy of modern Indian philanthropy: confident, compassionate, globally relevant, and uncompromisingly rooted in action. In redefining what it means to give in the 21st century, Dr. Payal Kanodia is not merely contributing to India's social story—she is helping shape its future narrative: one where progress is not a privilege, but a promise kept through purpose, partnership, and sustainability.

"Philanthropy today must operate at the scale of the challenges it seeks to solve. In 2026, our focus at M3M Foundation is on building replicable systems—where education feeds employability, women's economic participation strengthens resilience, and sustainability is embedded into growth. Development can no longer be episodic; it must be institutional"

– Dr Payal Kanodia.